

30,000 units easily. After that, we will be starting work on a new plant.

►►►

Would the increased capacity translate into a bigger revenue stream and will that finally make you profitable?

Ather will be a global player, with increased capacity outside of China. We will either be the No. 1 or the No. 2 two-wheeler manufacturer in the world. We are setting a target of \$1 billion in revenues for this [calendar] year but when it comes to being profitable, we are still some distance away.

84 | The losses continue to narrow but given the pace at which the market is progressing, there is a need to invest in infrastructure, charging grids and product enhancement. So, cash profitability is definitely not [going to happen] this year. It may happen in a year or two.

►►►

What differentiates Ather from other electric scooters?

Ather is the safest electric scooter in the market... one that's been built and researched for the longest period of time... We started work on the scooter in 2013... late 2012 and what you see on the road today is a product of research that has happened over 10 years.

It is also the first lo-

cally designed aluminium structure of a scooter. It is extremely stable and has a rigid frame, because of the weights used. Instead of using steel tubes, we have used aluminium and it is all bolted together. This makes the frame durable and light, and it can survive vibrations on the road. But the battery is at the heart of an Ather scooter. We were surprised [to find] that the battery in a scooter launched over four years ago was still at 85-90 per cent capacity. That is a reflection of how Ather is the best in this segment.

And, we have only

gotten better from there. With new generations being launched, there are more features that make the scooter more user-friendly. Like, with Ather Stack 5.0 we have introduced new modes, controls, [and] better navigation as a part of integrating Google Maps. It's almost magical how you can get the new features in an older bike as well, simply by doing a software upgrade.

►►►

Despite starting early, it took you a good four to five years to put a vehicle on the road. Today,

everybody wants to cash in on the first-mover advantage and customise according to the needs of the time. Do you believe in that?

During our early rounds of fundraising, Sachin [Bansal, Flipkart Co-founder and an investor in Ather] gave me some good advice and that was, we must stay true to ourselves. He said that we must not change anything in the deck for investors. So that's what we stick to. We stay true to ourselves and work towards building a resilient product. **BT**

@r_dhanrajani

